ROLE OF CABINET

1. It is the highest decision-making authority in our politico-administrative system.
2. It is the chief policy formulating body of the Central government.
3. It is the supreme executive authority of the Central government.
4. It is chief coordinator of Central administration.
5. It is an advisory body to the President and its advice is binding on him/her.
6. It is the chief crisis manager and thus deals with all emergency situations.
7. It deals with all major legislative and financial matters.
8. It exercises control over higher appointments like constitutional authorities and senior secretariat administrators.
9. It deals with all foreign policies and foreign affairs.

ROLE DESCRIPTIONS

The various comments made by the eminent political scientists and constitutional experts on the role of cabinet in Britain holds good in the Indian context also. These are mentioned below.

Ramsay Muir "The Cabinet is the steering wheel of the ship of the state."

Lowell "The Cabinet is the keystone of the political arch".

Sir John Marriott "The Cabinet is the pivot around which the whole political machinery revolves".

Gladstone "The Cabinet is the solar orb around which the other bodies revolve".

Barker "The Cabinet is the magnet of policy".

Bagehot "The Cabinet is a hyphen that joins, the buckle that binds the executive and legislative departments together".

Sir Ivor Jennings "The Cabinet is the core of the British Constitutional System. It provides unity to the British system of Government".

L.S. Amery "The Cabinet is the central directing instrument of Government".

The position of the Cabinet in the British Government has become so strong that Ramsay Muir referred to it as the 'Dictatorship of the Cabinet'. In his book '*How Britain is Governed*', he writes "A body which wields such powers as these may fairly be described as 'omnipotent' in theory, however, incapable it may be of using its omnipotence. Its position, whenever it commands a majority, is a dictatorship only qualified by publicity. This dictatorship is far more absolute that it was two generations ago". The same description holds good in the Indian context too.

KITCHEN CABINET